

Grade 4, Ch-4 , The Hero of Haarlem

Multiple Choice Questions

1. What was the little boy doing when he first noticed the hole in the dike?

- a) Playing with his friends
- b) On his way to school
- c) On his way back to home from Mr. Jansen's house.
- d) Fishing in the canal

Answer: c) On his way back to home from Mr. Jansen's house.

2. What would have happened if the hole in the dike was not blocked?

- a) The boy would be punished
- b) The fields would become more fertile
- c) The whole country could be flooded
- d) The dike would become stronger

Answer: c) The whole country could be flooded

3. How did the boy stop the water from flowing out of the dike?

- a) He used a stone to cover the hole
- b) He stuffed grass into the hole
- c) He put his hand into the hole
- d) He ran back to the village for help

Answer: c) He put his hand into the hole

4. Why did the boy stay near the dike all night?

- a) He was waiting for his father
- b) He was too scared to move
- c) He wanted to protect the town until help arrived
- d) He fell asleep there accidentally

Answer: c) He wanted to protect the town until help arrived

5. What qualities of the boy are shown through the story?

- a) Laziness and carelessness
- b) Bravery and responsibility
- c) Fear and weakness
- d) Greed and selfishness

Answer: b) Bravery and responsibility

Deep Dive

1) While the wind.....Hans as he passed.

- a) Where was Hans going?

Ans) Hans was going to deliver cakes to a blind man who lived across the dyke.

b) What was he worried about?

Ans) He was worried because the dykes were strained and swollen, and he feared they might break and flood the land.

c) Apart from dykes, which two other things mentioned in these two lines tell us where the story is set?

Ans) Windmills and tulips (both commonly found in Holland) are the two other things mentioned in these two lines that tell us where the story is set.

d) How is the setting of the story tied to the plot?

Ans) The story is set in Holland, a land below sea level, protected by dykes. The setting is crucial because the danger of the dykes breaking and flooding the land forms the central problem of the story, which Hans bravely prevents.

e) What natural forces are described in these lines?

Ans) The wind turning the windmills and the rain watering the tulips are the natural forces described.

2) The rain kept pelting..... break through the dyke.

a) How did Hans discover the leak in the dyke?

Hans discovered the leak when he heard the sound of trickling water while passing by the dyke. On checking, he found a small hole through which water was seeping.

b) Which quality or trait in Hans' character is brought out by these lines?

These lines show Hans' bravery, determination, and sense of responsibility towards his town.

c) What do you think motivated Hans to act in this manner?

Hans was motivated by his love for his town and concern for the safety of its people. His strong sense of duty and courage made him endure the storm to prevent a disaster.

Read, Reflect, and write

Q1) List the words and phrases from the story that describe the weather.

Words/phrases include: "*the rain kept pelting,*" "*the wind continued to swirl,*" "*stormy night,*" "*dark clouds gathered.*"

These show that the weather was stormy and rough.

Q2) Why do you think Mr. Jansen was always happy when Hans came to visit?

Mr. Jansen, being blind, was lonely. Hans' visits brought him companionship, joy, and kindness, which made him very happy. Mr. Jansen enjoyed telling Hans stories about how things were long ago.

Q3) Do you think *The Hero of Haarlem* is a good title for this story? Give a reason to support your answer. Suggest another suitable title for the story.

Yes, it is a good title because Hans' brave act of plugging the hole in the dyke saved the entire town of Haarlem from flooding, making him a true hero. Another suitable title could be: "Hans and the Leaking Dyke" or "The Brave Boy of Holland."

Ch-5 A Day to Remember

Deep Dive

1. *"The most important day I remember in all my life is the one on which my teacher came to me, three months before I was seven years old."*

a) Who is the narrator?

The narrator is Helen Keller.

b) How could the narrator guess that this day was important?

Helen Keller could guess that this day was important because it changed the course of her life — her teacher, Anne Sullivan, came and opened the world of knowledge and communication for her.

c) Why do you think the narrator says that the most important day of her life was the day her teacher came to her?

Because before meeting her teacher, Helen Keller lived in darkness and silence without understanding the world. Anne Sullivan's arrival gave her hope, learning, and a way to communicate, making it the most important day of her life.

d) From your reading of the story, what qualities do you think the narrator's teacher has?

Helen Keller's teacher, Anne Sullivan, was patient, loving, determined, and devoted. She had the ability to teach with kindness and persistence, never giving up until Helen understood.

2. *"Understanding that living word thrilled me, making me feel hope and joy. I felt free!"*

a) What had happened that made the narrator feel like this?

Helen Keller finally understood the meaning of the word "water" when her teacher Anne Sullivan spelled it into her hand while water flowed over the other hand.

b) Why does the author use the phrase 'living word'? Give reasons for your answer.

The phrase 'living word' is used because the word came alive with meaning for Helen. It was no longer just finger movements but something connected to the real world. It gave her the power to name things around her.

c) What do you think of the way the narrator was taught the meaning of a word when she did not understand it at first?

It was a brilliant and patient method. By connecting the word to a real-life object (water), Anne Sullivan helped Helen truly understand. This showed creativity, persistence, and dedication in teaching.

d) How do you learn words that have challenging meanings?

I learn challenging words by using a dictionary, looking for examples in sentences, and relating them to real-life objects or experiences. Sometimes I also break the word into smaller parts to understand it better.

Read, reflect and write

Q1) Do you think Anne Sullivan was an inspirational figure to Helen? Give reasons for your answer.

Ans) Yes, Anne Sullivan was truly an inspirational figure to Helen. She was patient, loving, and determined. She never gave up on Helen, even when Helen became frustrated. She connected words with real experiences, which opened the world of knowledge to Helen. Anne's guidance gave Helen hope, freedom, and a way to communicate, changing her life completely.

Q2) Our feelings tend to change as we experience different events in life. What feelings does Helen experience through the course of the narrative?

Ans) At first, Helen feels frustrated and confused because she cannot understand the words her teacher spells into her hand. Later, she feels curiosity and excitement while trying to learn. Finally, when she understands the meaning of the word “*water*”, she experiences joy, hope, freedom, and a sense of discovery.

Extra questions

Q1) What do you think is the 'mystery of language' that Helen solved that day?

Ans) The ‘mystery of language’ was the realization that every object has a name and that words are symbols for things and ideas. Helen understood that the finger movements her teacher made in her palm stood for the water flowing over her hand. This discovery opened the door for her to communicate and connect with the world.

Q2) What impression do the words 'silent' and 'dark' give you?

Ans) The words ‘*silent*’ and ‘*dark*’ describe Helen’s world before she learned language. They give the impression of loneliness, isolation, and being cut off from others. *Silent* suggests a world without sound, while *dark* suggests a world without sight. Together, they show how difficult life was for her before she discovered the power of words.

Poem: Foreign lands

2. Read the lines and answer the questions that follow.

a. **"I held the trunk with both my hands**

And looked abroad on foreign lands"

i) Who has climbed the tree? What tree is it?

Ans) The speaker (a little child) has climbed the tree. It is a cherry tree.

ii) What are the foreign lands that can be seen from the top of the tree?

Ans) From the top, the child can see gardens, houses, rivers, roads, and fields that look far away and new to him, like foreign lands.

iii) Are these really foreign lands? Why does the speaker say they are?

Ans) No, these are not really foreign lands. They appear foreign because the child has never seen them before from such a height and they seem distant and unknown.

b. *"If I could find a higher tree,
Farther and farther I should see."*

i) Why does the speaker wish to find a higher tree?

The speaker wishes to find a higher tree so that he can see more of the world around him and discover places that are hidden from his sight at a lower height.

ii) What does the speaker wish to see from the top of the higher tree?

He wishes to see distant lands, rivers, seas, and ships—places that look new and exciting to him.

iii) Why do you think the word 'farther' is repeated?

The word 'farther' is repeated to show the child's eagerness and excitement to see beyond what is near and to emphasize the vastness of the view from a higher place.

iv) What quality of the child is shown in this stanza?

The stanza shows the child's curiosity and imagination, as he longs to explore more of the world.

Q3) According to the poem *Foreign Lands*, would you like to travel and see foreign lands? What would you like to see?

Ans) Yes, I would love to travel and see foreign lands. I would like to see different countries, tall mountains, great rivers, seas with ships, and beautiful gardens and forests. Exploring new places would make me feel adventurous, just like the child in the poem.

Extra questions:

Q1) How does the poem *Foreign Lands* show the curiosity of a child?

Ans) The poem shows the curiosity of a child who climbs a cherry tree to see more of the world. From the top, he sees gardens, rivers, roads, and houses that look new and exciting. He even imagines foreign lands beyond his reach. This shows a child's imagination, sense of wonder, and eagerness to explore.

Q2) Describe what the child sees from the cherry tree.

Ans) From the cherry tree, the child sees the next-door garden full of flowers, many houses, roads, fields, and rivers. He also imagines foreign lands, rivers slipping into the sea, and ships sailing far away.

Q3) How does the poem reflect the imagination of a child?

Ans) The child's imagination makes ordinary things like houses, fields, and rivers appear like foreign lands. His curiosity and wonder show how children see the world differently from adults.